MattyG
TRADING

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THE 0 → 10K

ROADMAP

If I had to start trading over from zero, this is exactly the path I would take

READ THIS FIRST

This is the path I'd take if I had to start from scratch today, knowing what I know now. Its not a shortcut, get-rich-quick scheme, but just the real order of steps I would take do to skip all the skip the noise, protect your money early on, and set yourself up the right way to actually become profitable trader

There are basically three steps, and I recommend you don't skip ahead. Most blown accounts and losing capital early on come from people skipping straight to the straight up trading phase before they've actually learned the why or put in the screen time. You don’t want to be that guy cause it’ll just send you in circles

> **Important Note**
> 10K is just a example milestone I use, to set up some kind of goal and direction. The traders who truly excel and get there are the ones who fall in love with the **process.** The charting, the journaling, the boring reps that you really want to skip. Trust me, those are the most important parts to learn. If you're just chasing the number and trying to make money fast, you'll never actually get there. Trust the process and develop a system first.

The three steps

- LEARN — Build the foundation. This is Free education, no live capital yet, and what will set you up for success.
- PRACTICE — This is where you’ll apply what you learned in a simulation environment until it clicks, and you are confident that you have an edge and you’re ready to risk your own money.
- APPLY — Now you will actually trade for real, but through prop firms first, because protecting your own capital early on is very important. The goal is staying in the game as long as possible

01 LEARN

This is where everyone wants to skip. Don't. Trust me, it may seem boring at first, but the more you learn, the more you'll understand that love for trading people have. The single biggest reason people fail in this game is they go live before they understand why price moves, proper market structure and concepts, proper risk management and the trading mindset. They learn entries and how to buy and sell before they learn about the market. You want to do it the other way around.

Three free resources will get you 80% of the way there. Both are on YouTube, both are free, and both are better than 99% of the paid courses being sold right now. Then when you add the psychology layer on top and you have the foundation most people don't bother to teach

> **WHY I PICKED THESE**
> Since I don't have my own content complete yet, these are people in the space who I trust and learned from as well. ICT is the foundation of everything. Every single ICT/SMC educator you see on YouTube most likely learned from him. Dodgy translates ICT into beginner-friendly language. Rande Howell handles the head game better than anyone else I know.

ICT 2022 Mentorship

- Full playlist — https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=GKeLVR3dPuI&list=PLVgHx4Z63paaM41aubnHOmqfeNjSAoBCV

This is the source material. Every concept I use - liquidity, market structure, daily bias, session highs and lows, all traces back to ICT. The 2022 Mentorship covers all the essentials you need to know and it's all free on YouTube.

Heads up: ICT teaches like he's talking to himself. It's dense. It's slow. You might need to rewatch episodes. That's normal and that's the point - *these concepts need to sink in*. Don't try to binge it. Watch one episode, take notes, then go look at the charts and find what he just showed you.

How to attack it: 1-3 episode per day. Take notes. During and After every episode, open TradingView and find real examples of whatever concept he just covered. Practice marking up your chart like he does Don't move to the next episode until you've really got it.

Dodgy Bootcamp

- Full playlist — https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=H2EN5EZb7Rs&list=PLlTMN9ywFuLoQe0fBAbwDj7FVLnZg5VvF

Dodgy takes ICT concepts and makes them way more digestible. ICT is kind of the textbook, and Dodgy is the study guide. He's more entertaining, clean, structured, and explains the same ideas in plain English. Watch this in parallel with ICT, not after.

The one thing to watch out for: Dodgy can get deep into things before you have the basic vocabulary and knowledge. If you find yourself lost, that's a signal to go back to the early ICT episodes and shore up the foundation, don't just keep going and pretend you got it.

How to attack it: Use Dodgy to reinforce what you just learned from ICT. If ICT covers fair value gaps on Monday, watch Dodgy's FVG video Monday night. Same concept, two angles, way deeper understanding.

Rande Howell — Trading Psychology

Nobody wants to talk about this part and that's exactly why it matters. You can have the cleanest setup in the world, a winning trading strategy and still blow accounts because of fear, revenge trading, FOMO, chasing, etc. Rande Howell is the guy who really fixed this for me and a lot of traders I respect.

Videos

1. Mastering the Mind of a Trader
2. Conquering Fear in Trading
3. Becoming a Disciplined Trader

If you prefer to read –

- https://tradersstateofmind.com/

His stuff lives on YouTube and his website

How to attack it: Don't binge this either. Watch one video per week through the Learn and Practice phases and take notes. Psychology work is a long game and the lessons hit different once you've actually felt the emotions in real trades.

How to know you're ready to leave the Learn phase

- You can explain what liquidity is, why price reaches for it, and where the obvious pools sit on a chart, in your own words.
- You can identify the daily bias before New York open and articulate why.
- You can mark up a chart with market structure, premium/discount, and key levels without second-guessing every line.
- You can see trades forming and playing out, and understand why price is moving and reacting the way it does.

> **Check Yourself**
> If you can't teach a concept to a friend without notes, you don't actually know it yet. Move on once you can be the teacher, not just the student.

02 PRACTICE

Now you take what you learned, and test it on real charts in real time, but with zero dollars at risk. This is where the you start applying the concepts you learned and start turning it into muscle memory. If you skip this phase and I promise unfortunately you will just donate money to prop firms and brokers.

TradingView Practice Account

TradingView's paper trading account is the move. It's free, it's good, and it’s already inside the same platform you're going to use forever. Set up a paper account with realistic capital. Match what you'll actually trade with on a prop firm. If you're planning to take a 50K eval, paper trade with 50K. If 100K, paper trade with 100K.

> **SET IT UP LIKE AND TRADE LIKE ITS REAL**
> The main mistake people make in paper trading is treating it like a video game. Set the account size to your real future starting size. Set realistic risk per trade. If this was your actual hard-earned money, you wouldn’t be gambling it like monopoly. Treat it like its your own to lose, because eventually it will be.

How to practice

- Trade the same session every single day. New York AM (9am-12pm) is where I'd start. There is a clear narrative, high liquidity, manageable hours. Outside of that you can look at the charts the whole day if you really want. This will help you see how volume and time play into how the market moves. You’ll See how morning compares to afternoon compares to night, and what each session does.
- Limit yourself to 1-3 setups per day. Don't try to learn five strategies at once, take 50 trades. Look for the best ones that you’ve learned. Master one strategy/concept, then add the next.
- Journal every trade. Entry, exit, reason for entry, reason for exit, what you saw, what you missed, why you took the trade. Add Screenshots too.
- Review your journal every week - Ido Sundays. Look for patterns in your wins and your losses. The journal is where the lessons live, and how you improve.
- Track stats: win rate, average R, max drawdown, expectancy. You can't improve what you don't measure.

How long to practice

Minimum 30 trading days. That's roughly 1-2 months of consistent screen time. I know that sounds long. It's won’t be. The traders who try to compress this phase are the ones who blow up in the apply phase. The ones who give it the time become the traders who actually make it.

How to know you're ready to leave the Practice phase

- 30+ trading days logged with full journal entries.
- Profitable over the last 30 trading days (not just one or two big wins covering a string of losses, you want to actually consistent.
- Holding strict proper risk per trade.
- You can sit out for a day with zero setups without forcing a trade.
- Your A+ setup has defined checklist, and confirmations that you can identify, speak out loud, and you can list it without thinking.

THE HARDEST PART

Sitting on your hands when there's no setup is harder than entering a trade. If you can't do it when where there's no money on the line, you'll definitely not be able to do it when its real. Trust me I would know lol. Boredom kills more accounts than bad setups do. *In trading you get paid to wait.*

03 APPLY

This is where it gets real. Bur you are not funding a personal account first. You are going through prop firms.

WHY PROP FIRMS FIRST

Prop firms let you risk only about 100 bucks to potentially get a funded 50K account. So basically, you are risking 100$ only to potentially unlimited gains. If you blow the eval, you're out a hundred or two. If you blow your own account with 5K in it, you down 5k, and probably your motivation with it as well. Prop firms let you trade with serious size while protecting your own capital. There is no scenario where a beginner should fund a personal account before passing prop firm evals. The live accounts come after.

The 5 prop firms I'd use

Listed in the order I'd attack them. This isn't the only order that works, you can obviously experiment how you want, but this is the one that gives you the best mix of cost, beginner-friendly rules, fair payout structure, and reputation. Don't try to run all five at once. Pick one, start 1 account, pass it, then scale.

#	FIRM	WHY IT'S ON THE LIST
1	**Apex Trader**	Cheapest accounts on the market. The flip side is the rules are stricter and can bite if you're not careful.
2	**Lucid Trading**	Top starting pick for new traders. Clean rules, beginner-friendly drawdown structure, and the platform doesn't punish you for breathing wrong.
3	**Tradeify**	Solid second move. Reasonable rules, good payout structure, and the eval is fair. A nice complement to Lucid for layering multiple accounts.
4	**TopStep**	The household name. Been around the longest, most respected reputation in the space. Passing TopStep is a real proof point.
5	**Alpha Futures**	I have an active affiliate relationship with Alpha so I'm transparent about that. They earned it though it’s a solid platform, fair rules, and they treat funded traders well.

How to actually run an eval

- Trade the eval like it's a funded account. Same risk, same setups, same hours. Don't suddenly become a different trader because there's an eval on the line.
- Most evals fail in the first three days because people overtrade trying to hit the profit target fast. Slow down. Time is on your side.
- If you hit the max loss limit, you're done. Don’t risk the whole drawdown each day. I like to risk 10% of the max drawdown to about 1% of the account size.
- Read every rule in the firm's handbook before you take any trade. Knowing the rules is part of the job.
- If you fail an eval, journal exactly why before you buy a reset. If you can't articulate the mistake, you'll repeat it. But don’t fret, blowing accounts is something that happens to everyone eventually. It’s a learning moment, not a failure.

Once you're funded

The hardest part of prop trading isn't passing the eval, it's keeping the funded account. The mindset shift is real. Most people pass and then immediately blow up because they start trading bigger or differently because you can actually start making real money. Trade the funded account the exact same way you traded the eval.

FINAL WORD

The path is simple. The work is not.

Everything in this roadmap is free or close to free. The actual cost is time, reps, and emotional discipline. In trading there's no shortcut, no secret indicator, nothing that's actually going to do the work for you. Once you start, you're probably not ever going to want to stop either. This can be a challenge, but is a blessing as well, because trading truly has the potential to change your life, if you really want it.

If you do the Learn phase right, the Practice phase honestly, and the Apply phase patiently, I promise you'll get to that first 1k, 10K or whatever goal you have set for yourself. The ones who learn it and don't skip any steps, and try to do I quick, are the once who succeed. You got this.

WHATS NEXT

Want a community to walk this path with? I run a free Discord where all of this already happens. Daily live streams of my trading so you can learn visually, trade recaps, and a community of traders who actually want to make it. The free tier has plenty to get you started. VIP is where you can watch me live every day and get full access to my calls, recaps, and teaching. Walk through it before you pay for anything.

Want 1:1 guidance? I offer 1:1 mentorship for traders who want a faster, personalized path. We work through whatever you're stuck on, your questions, your charts, your psychology, and get you to where you need to be.

All links are in my socials and in the Discord.